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Sleeper Trains Make a Comeback in Europe

By Daniel · 2026-08-17 · 270 words · L2



야간 열차가 다시 늘어나는 이유

For decades, overnight trains were seen as slow and outdated. Now they are coming back — and younger travelers are leading the way.

Across Europe, more and more people are choosing to sleep on a train rather than board a short-haul flight. Booking numbers for sleeper train services have risen by around 147 percent in recent years, reflecting a sharp shift in how travelers think about getting from one city to another.

Much of this change is driven by environmental concern. Flying produces significantly more carbon emissions per passenger than rail

travel, and growing awareness of climate change has pushed many people to look for greener options. Younger travelers, in particular, have become strong supporters of low-emission transport, and night trains fit that need well.

Austria's national rail operator, ÖBB, has become one of the most active players in this revival. The company has expanded its sleeper services across Europe and even acquired extra train cars from Germany to meet rising demand. New routes now connect major cities that previously had no direct overnight rail link, making it easier for travelers to skip the airport entirely.

The appeal goes beyond environmental reasons. A sleeper train lets passengers skip the stress of airport check-ins, arrive in a new city in the morning already rested, and see the landscape along the way. Some routes pass through mountain valleys and scenic countryside that no flight can offer.

Governments across Europe have also begun investing in rail infrastructure to support the trend. If funding continues and more routes open, the overnight train could become a serious competitor to short-haul flights within the next decade.

한글 요약

유럽에서 야간열차 이용이 부활하고 있으며, 침대차 서비스 예약 건수가 최근 약 147퍼센트 증가했다. 이러한 변화는 항공 여행에 비해 탄소 배출량이 적은 친환경 이동 수단을 선호하는 젊은 세대의 의식 변화가 주된 요인으로 작용하고 있다. 오스트리아 국영 철도 운영사 ÖBB는 노선 확대와 추가 객차 인수를 통해 이 같은 수요 증가에 적극 대응하고 있다. 각국 정부의 철도 인프라 투자가 계속된다면, 야간열차는 향후 10년 안에 단거리 항공편의 실질적인 대안으로 자리잡을 것으로 전망된다.

WORDS & MEANINGS

outdated 구식의, 시대에 뒤떨어진
short-haul 단거리의 (항공편 등)
emission 배출, 배기가스
revival 부활, 재유행

infrastructure 기반 시설
scenic 경치가 좋은
competitor 경쟁자, 경쟁 상대

Can Democracies Defend Against Election Misinformation?

By Daniel · 2026-08-17 · 296 words · L3



가짜 정보와 선거 제도의 방어

Elections are the foundation of democratic systems, yet they face a growing threat that does not come from ballot boxes or voting machines. False information — deliberately created and spread to mislead voters — is now one of the most serious challenges that democracies face.

Misinformation in elections is not new. Rumors and propaganda have influenced voters for centuries. What has changed is the speed and scale at which false content can now reach millions of people through social media platforms and messaging apps.

Artificial intelligence has made the problem harder to manage. AI tools can now generate realistic fake videos, fabricated quotes from politicians, and convincing

false news articles in seconds. Researchers note that these capabilities are making it significantly more difficult for voters to distinguish real information from invented content.

Electoral authorities in several countries have responded by setting up dedicated fact-checking units and working with technology companies to remove misleading posts before they spread widely. Some governments have also introduced new legislation requiring platforms to act more quickly when false content is reported.

Critics argue, however, that these measures are often too slow. By the time a false story is removed, it may already have been shared hundreds of thousands of times. Experts

point to studies showing that false information spreads faster online than accurate reporting does.

Media literacy education is seen as one of the most effective long-term responses. Teaching citizens — especially young voters — how to verify sources and question what they read online may reduce the impact of misinformation over time.

What makes this issue particularly complex is that the line between honest political opinion and deliberate manipulation is not always clear. Defining and regulating misinformation without limiting free speech remains an unresolved challenge for governments around the world.

한글 요약

소셜 미디어와 인공지능의 발달로 허위 정보가 유례없는 속도와 규모로 확산되면서 선거의 공정성이 심각한 위협에 처해 있다. 각국 선거 당국과 정부는 팩트체크 부서 운영 및 관련 입법을 통해 대응에 나서고 있으나, 허위 정보가 삭제되기 전에 이미 광범위하게 퍼진다는 한계가 지적된다. 전문가들은 시민들이 정보를 비판적으로 검증하는 능력을 기르는 미디어 리터러시 교육을 가장 효과적인 장기 대응책으로 꼽는다. 그러나 정치적 의견과 의도적 조작의 경계가 불분명한 탓에, 표현의 자유를 침해하지 않으면서 허위 정보를 규제하는 문제는 여전히 해결되지 않은 과제로 남아 있다.

WORDS & MEANINGS

misinformation 잘못된 정보, 허위 정보
deliberate 의도적인, 고의적인
propaganda 선전, 프로파간다
fabricated 조작된, 날조된

legislation 법률, 입법
verify 확인하다, 검증하다
manipulation 조작, 교묘한 통제

Should College Be Free for Everyone?

By Daniel · 2026-08-17 · 303 words · L3



대학 무상화 논쟁의 국제 비교

Around the world, governments are debating one big question: who should pay for higher education? Some countries have decided that university should be free for all students, while others rely heavily on tuition fees, and the gap between these two approaches remains wide.

In several European countries, including Denmark, Germany, and Norway, public universities charge little or no tuition. These governments fund higher education directly through taxes, believing that an educated population benefits society as a whole.

Argentina takes a similar approach, with its public universities being free and open to all — a policy that dates back decades. Supporters say free university gives

students from lower-income families a fair chance at success.

On the other end of the scale, countries like the United States and the United Kingdom have some of the highest tuition costs in the world. In the US, students often take out large loans to pay for a four-year degree. Many carry that debt for years after graduation.

Critics of high-tuition systems argue that heavy debt discourages students from lower-income families from enrolling at all. When education costs too much, talented students may never reach their full potential.

However, free university systems are not without problems. Countries that offer free

higher education must spend a great deal of public money. Some economists warn that this level of spending is difficult to maintain over time. There are also concerns about whether free systems can consistently keep the quality of education high enough.

Some countries try to find a middle path by offering reduced tuition, income-based grants, or loan programs with low interest rates, hoping to balance access with financial reality.

What makes this debate especially interesting is that no single model works perfectly for every country. A nation's population size, economy, and cultural values all shape how it funds education.

한글 요약

전 세계 각국은 고등 교육 비용을 누가 부담해야 하는지를 둘러싸고 첨예한 논쟁을 벌이고 있으며, 덴마크·독일·노르웨이·아르헨티나 등은 세금으로 재원을 조달하는 무상 대학 교육을 시행하는 반면, 미국과 영국은 세계 최고 수준의 등록금을 유지하고 있다. 고등교육 체계 비판론자들은 과중한 학자금 부채가 저소득층 학생들의 대학 진학 자체를 억제한다고 주장한다. 반면 무상 교육 체계도 막대한 공공 지출이 요구되어 장기적 지속 가능성과 교육 질 유지에 대한 우려를 낳는다. 이에 따라 일부 국가들은 소득 기반 보조금이나 저금리 대출 등을 통해 접근성과 재정 현실 사이의 균형을 찾는 절충안을 모색하고 있다.

WORDS & MEANINGS

tuition 수업료, 등록금
debate 토론, 논쟁
fund 자금을 지원하다
enrollment 입학, 등록

loan 대출, 빌린 돈
grant 보조금, 지원금
maintain 유지하다

Arctic Routes Open, Global Competition Heats Up

By Daniel · 2026-08-17 · 127 words · L1



북극 항로 개방과 새로운 경쟁

As Arctic sea ice continues to melt, new shipping routes through the far north are becoming easier to use. These routes can cut the distance between Asia and Europe by thousands of kilometers, saving time and fuel for ships.

Several major powers, including the United States, Russia, and China, are competing for influence in the region. Russia controls much of the Northern Sea Route along its coast and has been expanding its

presence there. China has also declared a strong interest in Arctic shipping and resources.

The opening of these routes raises important questions about territorial rights and international law. Analysts warn that without clear agreements, tensions between competing nations could grow. For now, the Arctic remains one of the most closely watched regions in global politics.

한글 요약

북극 해빙의 가속화로 아시아와 유럽을 잇는 새로운 북극 항로가 개통 가능성이 높아지고 있으며, 이는 항해 거리와 연료 비용의 획기적인 절감을 의미한다. 러시아는 북방항로에 대한 실효적 지배를 강화하고 있으며, 중국 역시 북극 자원과 항로에 대한 전략적 이해관계를 공식화하고 있다. 미국을 포함한 강대국들이 이 지역에서 영향력 확대를 위해 치열하게 경쟁하면서, 영토권 및 국제법을 둘러싼 분쟁 가능성이 높아지고 있다. 전문가들은 명확한 국제적 합의 없이는 북극을 둘러싼 강대국 간 긴장이 심화될 수 있다고 경고하며, 북극은 현재 국제 정치의 핵심 화두로 부상하고 있다.

WORDS & MEANINGS

route 경로, 항로

influence 영향력

territorial 영토의

presence 존재, 세력

competing 경쟁하는

tension 긴장, 갈등

expand 확장하다

The Hidden Cost of Poor Mental Health

By Daniel · 2026-08-17 · 303 words · L3



정신 건강 관리의 사회적 비용

Mental illness affects hundreds of millions of people worldwide, yet its economic impact is rarely discussed as openly as its human toll. Governments and researchers are now paying closer attention to just how much untreated mental health conditions cost societies each year.

The costs fall into two broad categories: direct costs and indirect costs. Direct costs include hospital visits, medication, and therapy. Indirect costs — which are often far larger — include lost work hours, reduced productivity, and early retirement caused by illness.

A report from the United Kingdom estimated that mental illness costs the country roughly £117.9 billion per year, equal to about five percent of GDP. Around

three-quarters of that figure comes from lost productivity rather than healthcare spending alone.

The picture is similar in other high-income countries. Researchers studying untreated mental illness in one US state found that the total societal costs reached billions of dollars annually when healthcare expenses, lost income, and other related costs were combined.

Experts point out that early intervention tends to reduce long-term costs significantly. When people receive support before their condition becomes severe, they are more likely to remain employed and need fewer emergency services.

Yet many countries still spend less than five percent of their health budgets on mental health, according to the World Health Organization. This gap between the scale of the problem and the level of funding is a major concern among health researchers.

What makes this issue particularly striking is that depression and anxiety — the most common mental health conditions — are also among the most treatable. Economists argue that investing in mental health care is not only a social responsibility but also a practical financial decision for governments.

As awareness grows globally, more countries are being urged to treat mental health with the same urgency as physical health.

한글 요약

정신 질환은 전 세계 수억 명에게 영향을 미치며, 치료받지 못할 경우 의료 비용만 아니라 생산성 손실과 조기 퇴직 등 막대한 간접 비용을 사회에 부과한다. 영국의 경우 정신 질환으로 인한 연간 비용이 GDP의 약 5%에 해당하는 1,179억 파운드로 추산되며, 그 대부분은 생산성 손실에서 비롯된다. 세계보건기구에 따르면 여전히 많은 국가들이 보건 예산의 5% 미만을 정신 건강에 지출하고 있어, 문제의 심각성에 비해 투자가 현저히 부족한 실정이다. 전문가들은 우울증과 불안 장애처럼 치료 가능성이 높은 질환에 조기 개입과 충분한 재정 투자가 이루어진다면 사회적 비용을 크게 절감할 수 있다고 강조한다.

WORDS & MEANINGS

productivity	생산성	funding	자금 지원
intervention	개입, 조치	anxiety	불안
societal	사회적인	GDP	국내총생산
severity	심각성		

Cities Rethink Flood Management From the Ground Up

By Daniel · 2026-08-17 · 283 words · L3



도시 홍수와 빗물 관리 인프라

Heavy rainfall has always posed a challenge for cities, but climate change is making storms more intense and more frequent. As a result, urban flooding is now a serious concern for city planners and governments around the world.

Traditional cities rely heavily on concrete and asphalt, surfaces that water cannot pass through. When heavy rain falls, this water rushes into drainage systems that were often built decades ago and were not designed to handle today's volumes.

When those systems become overwhelmed, streets flood, basements fill with water, and in serious cases, lives are put at risk. The

economic damage from urban flooding runs into billions of dollars each year globally.

In response, many cities are turning to what researchers call 'sponge city' designs. The core idea is to let the ground absorb and store rainwater naturally, rather than rushing it into pipes.

Practical measures include planting more trees and green spaces, building rain gardens, and installing permeable paving — surfaces that allow water to soak through into the soil below. Rooftop gardens and constructed wetlands are also being used in various cities.

China has been one of the most active adopters of this approach, having launched a

national sponge city program that covers dozens of cities. European cities such as Copenhagen and Rotterdam have also invested heavily in green drainage infrastructure after experiencing major flood events.

Experts point to a key challenge: upgrading existing city infrastructure is expensive and slow, particularly in densely built areas. Governments must balance short-term costs against the long-term savings that better flood management can bring.

For students, the sponge city concept is a useful reminder that solving modern problems often means working with nature rather than against it.

한글 요약

기후 변화로 폭우의 강도와 빈도가 증가하면서 도시 침수가 전 세계적으로 심각한 문제로 부상하고 있으며, 기존의 콘크리트 기반 배수 시스템은 현재의 강우량을 감당하기 어려운 실정이다. 이에 대한 해결책으로 빗물을 자연적으로 흡수·저장하는 '스펀지 도시' 설계가 주목받고 있으며, 투수성 포장재, 빗물 정원, 옥상 정원, 인공 습지 등 다양한 녹색 인프라가 활용되고 있다. 중국은 국가 단위의 스펀지 도시 프로그램을 추진하고 있으며, 코펜하겐과 로테르담 등 유럽 주요 도시들도 대규모 홍수 피해 이후 관련 인프라에 적극 투자하고 있다. 다만 기존 도시 인프라 개선에는 막대한 비용과 긴 시간이 소요되는 만큼, 단기 비용과 장기적 홍수 피해 절감 효과 사이의 균형을 고려한 정책적 판단이 요구된다.

WORDS & MEANINGS

asphalt	아스팔트	infrastructure	기반 시설
drainage	배수(시스템)	wetland	습지
permeable	투수성의, 물이 스며드는	overwhelmed	감당할 수 없게 된, 압도된
absorb	흡수하다		

Satellites Are Now Watching Greenhouse Gas Emissions

By Daniel · 2026-08-17 · 262 words · L2



위성 관측으로 감시하는 온실가스

For decades, scientists had to rely on ground-based sensors and estimates to track greenhouse gas emissions. Now, a new generation of satellites is changing that — giving researchers a direct view of pollution sources from hundreds of kilometers above Earth.

NASA's OCO-2 satellite, launched in 2014, measures carbon dioxide levels in the atmosphere with high precision. It collects data across wide areas, allowing scientists to identify where CO2 concentrations are unusually high. Research using OCO-2 data has shown clear emission signals rising above

industrial regions and power plants in various parts of the world.

Methane is another gas that satellites are now helping to monitor. In early 2024, MethaneSAT — a satellite developed by a nonprofit organization linked to the Environmental Defense Fund — was launched specifically to track methane leaking from oil and gas operations. Methane is a powerful greenhouse gas, and reducing leaks from the energy sector is seen as one of the fastest ways to slow climate change in the near term.

One reason satellite monitoring matters so much is that it provides independent data. Countries and companies are

expected to report their own emissions, but those self-reported numbers are difficult to verify. Space-based observation gives scientists and policymakers a second source of information that is harder to dispute.

Experts say the technology is still improving. Researchers and space agencies are working toward satellites that cover more gases, offer sharper detail, and update data more frequently. As the tools become more powerful, satellite monitoring could play a central role in holding governments and industries accountable for their climate commitments.

한글 요약

새로운 세대의 위성들이 지상 센서와 추정치에 의존하던 기존 방식을 대체하며 온실가스 배출원을 직접 관측하는 것이 가능해졌다. NASA의 OCO-2 위성은 이산화탄소 농도를 고정밀로 측정하고, 2024년 발사된 MethaneSAT는 석유·가스 시설의 메탄 누출을 전담 추적한다. 위성 모니터링의 가장 큰 강점은 각국 정부와 기업의 자체 보고 수치를 검증할 수 있는 독립적인 데이터를 제공한다는 점이다. 기술이 지속적으로 발전함에 따라 위성 감시는 정부와 산업계의 기후 공약 이행을 견인하는 핵심 수단으로 자리잡을 것으로 전망된다.

Source · [ncbi.nlm.nih.gov](#), [npr.org](#)

WORDS & MEANINGS

emission 배출, 방출
atmosphere 대기, 분위기
concentration 농도, 집중
methane 메탄 (온실가스의 일종)

verify 확인하다, 검증하다
accountable 책임이 있는
policy maker 정책 입안자

Can the World Agree to Cut Plastic?

By Daniel · 2026-08-17 · 275 words · L2



플라스틱 국제 협약의 쟁점

Every year, more than 400 million tonnes of plastic are produced worldwide, and only a small fraction is ever recycled. Since 2022, representatives from over 170 countries have been meeting to write a global treaty on plastic pollution — but reaching an agreement has proved far more difficult than many had hoped.

The central dispute is over whether the treaty should limit how much plastic is produced in the first place. Countries with major petrochemical industries, such as Saudi Arabia, Russia, and Iran, argue that the focus should be on improving waste management and recycling rather than cutting production.

Higher-ambition nations — including many European countries and small island states — say that tackling waste alone is not enough and that production must be reduced at the source.

A second major disagreement involves chemicals. Plastics contain hundreds of chemical additives, some of which are linked to health risks. Environmental groups and many scientists want the treaty to ban the most harmful substances. Industry representatives, however, say that strict chemical controls would make plastics far less useful and expensive to produce.

Financing is a third sticking point. Developing nations say they need

significant financial support to build better waste infrastructure and shift away from cheap plastic. Wealthier countries have not yet agreed on how much to contribute or through what mechanism.

Talks in Busan, South Korea, in late 2024 ended without a final agreement, and new negotiations are expected to continue in 2025. Experts say the outcome will depend on how willing major producing nations are to accept binding commitments. A successful treaty could set a precedent for how the world handles other global pollution problems.

한글 요약

전 세계 170개국 이상이 2022년부터 플라스틱 오염을 규제하는 국제 조약 체결을 위해 협상을 진행해 왔으나, 아직 최종 합의에 이르지 못하고 있다. 주요 쟁점은 플라스틱 생산량 자체를 제한할 것인가를 둘러싼 산유국과 고의욕 국가 간의 대립, 유해 화학 첨가물 규제 수준, 그리고 개발도상국에 대한 재정 지원 방식의 세 가지로 압축된다. 2024년 말 부산에서 열린 협상이 합의 없이 종료됨에 따라, 추가 협상은 2025년으로 이어질 전망이다. 전문가들은 조약의 성패가 주요 생산국들의 구속력 있는 의무 수용 여부에 달려 있으며, 성공적인 합의는 지구적 오염 문제 해결의 중요한 선례가 될 것이라고 강조한다.

WORDS & MEANINGS

treaty 조약, 협약

fraction 일부, 소수

petrochemical 석유화학의

additive 첨가물

infrastructure 기반 시설

binding 법적 구속력이 있는

precedent 선례, 전례

Climate Change Pushes Grain Prices Higher

By Daniel · 2026-08-17 · 268 words · L2



곡물 가격과 기후 변동의 연쇄

When harvests fail across multiple regions at the same time, the effects spread quickly through global food markets. Climate change is making that scenario more common, and grain prices are rising as a result.

Wheat and maize are among the crops most vulnerable to shifting weather patterns. Higher temperatures reduce yields, prolonged droughts dry out soil, and extreme rainfall events can destroy harvests that took months to grow. Researchers studying long-term agricultural data note that soil degradation — the gradual loss of nutrients and

structure — is making farmland less productive over time.

The economic consequences are significant. When grain supplies fall short of demand, prices rise on international commodity markets. Countries that depend heavily on food imports face particularly sharp increases. For lower-income nations, higher grain prices can push basic foods out of reach for large portions of the population.

Research on East Asian agriculture adds another layer of complexity. Studies on China, Japan, and South Korea suggest that the effects of climate change on grain production will not be uniform. Some

northern regions of China may see rice yields increase as temperatures warm, while wheat production in several areas is projected to decline by roughly 10 percent by 2050. Analysts warn that such regional differences will reshape global trade flows and create new supply uncertainties.

For consumers around the world, the connection between climate and food costs is becoming harder to ignore. Governments and agricultural experts are now focusing on developing heat-resistant crop varieties and improving water management systems. How quickly those efforts scale up may determine how stable food prices remain in the decades ahead.

한글 요약

기후변화로 인한 동시다발적 흉작이 세계 식량 시장에서 곡물 가격 상승을 초래하고 있으며, 특히 식량 수입 의존도가 높은 저소득 국가들이 큰 타격을 받고 있다. 밀과 옥수수를 비롯한 주요 곡물은 기온 상승, 가뭄, 폭우 등 극단적 기상 현상에 취약하며, 토양 황폐화가 장기적인 생산성 저하를 가속화하고 있다. 동아시아 지역 연구에 따르면 기후변화의 영향은 지역별로 상이하게 나타날 전망으로, 중국 일부 북부 지역의 쌀 생산량은 증가하는 반면 밀 생산량은 2050년까지 약 10퍼센트 감소할 것으로 예측된다. 각국 정부와 전문가들은 내열성 작물 품종 개발과 수자원 관리 개선에 나서고 있으며, 이러한 대응책의 확대 속도가 향후 식품 가격 안정의 핵심 변수가 될 것이다.

WORDS & MEANINGS

harvest 수확, 수확량

commodity 상품, 원자재

degradation 악화, 저하

yield 수확량, 산출량

vulnerable 취약한

projected 예상된, 전망된

uniform 균일한, 일정한

Can Immigration Fix a Shrinking Workforce?

By Daniel · 2026-08-17 · 136 words · L1



노동력 감소와 이민 정책의 쟁점

Many countries are facing a serious problem: they do not have enough workers. Birth rates are falling in places like South Korea, Japan, and several European nations, and older workers are retiring faster than young people can replace them. This leaves hospitals, farms, and factories short-staffed.

One common solution is to welcome more immigrant workers. In the United States, legal work-related immigration dropped by roughly one-third between 2020 and 2024, and economists link this directly to

labor shortages in areas like healthcare and construction. Some governments, however, are tightening immigration rules, making it harder for foreign workers to enter.

The debate comes down to a difficult trade-off. Stricter immigration policies may satisfy some voters, but they can also make workforce shortages worse. Many economists argue that without more open immigration, aging economies will struggle to grow.

한글 요약

출생률 저하와 고령 인구 증가로 인해 한국, 일본, 유럽 등 여러 국가에서 심각한 노동력 부족 현상이 나타나고 있다. 이민 노동자 유입은 대표적인 해결책으로 꼽히지만, 미국에서는 2020년부터 2024년 사이 합법적 취업 이민자 수가 약 3분의 1 감소하며 의료·건설 분야의 인력난이 악화되었다. 일부 정부가 이민 규제를 강화하는 추세 속에서, 경제학자들은 이러한 정책이 노동력 부족을 더욱 심화시킬 수 있다고 경고한다. 결국 이민 정책의 방향은 유권자 여론과 경제적 필요 사이의 어려운 균형을 어떻게 맞추느냐에 달려 있다.

Source · npr.org, theconversation.com

WORDS & MEANINGS

workforce 노동력, 전체 근로자

shortage 부족, 결핍

retire 은퇴하다

immigration 이민, 이주

economist 경제학자

tighten 강화하다, 엄격하게 하다

trade-off 절충, 상충 관계

스크랩하기 Scrap It!

이름 _____ 날짜 _____ 학교 · 반 _____

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